

Technical Details for Interns

Monitoring Online Trade of Cranes and Waterbirds

1. Purpose of the Monitoring

The web scraping and manual monitoring system aims to detect, document, and analyze online activities related to the illegal trade of cranes and selected waterbird species on social media platforms and online marketplaces.

The objective is to identify posts where cranes or other waterbirds are advertised, offered for sale, requested for purchase, hunted, trapped, or transported.

Interns will help collect publicly available information from online platforms to understand:

- Which species are being traded
- Where [and when](#) the trade is occurring
- The platforms used for trade
- The quantity and price of birds offered
- The purpose of trade (pet, meat, hunting, etc.)

This information will help conservation organizations and authorities understand patterns of illegal wildlife trade.

2. Platforms to Monitor

Interns will monitor publicly accessible content on platforms such as:

- Facebook
- Instagram
- Telegram
- TikTok (videos showing animals for sale)
- YouTube (sometimes used for advertising birds or hunting)
- X / Twitter (posts linking to sellers)
- VK (VKontakte)
- Online marketplaces (e.g., OLX)
- Other websites or forums where birds are traded

- Lalafo (Central Asia)

3. Key variable to collect

Variable	Definition	Example
Record ID	Unique ID for each detected trade instance	CAF-TRADE-001
Platform	Social media or website where the post was detected	Facebook, Telegram
URL / Link	Direct link to the post or listing	Facebook post link
Date of Post	Date when the advertisement or post was uploaded	12-Feb-26
Date Collected	Date when the record was documented by the team	13-Feb-26
Species Name	Species being offered for sale or mentioned	Demoiselle Crane
Scientific Name	Taxonomic name of the species	<i>Anthropoides virgo</i>
Common Trade Term	Local or slang name used in the post	“Demoiselle bird”
Species Group	Crane / Waterbird / Other bird	Crane
Purpose of Trade	Reason for trade mentioned or inferred	Pet, meat, hunting, falconry
Quantity	Number of birds mentioned in the advertisement	3 cranes
Price	Price mentioned in post (if available)	50 USD
Location Mentioned	Location stated in the advertisement	Lahore
Probable Location	Location inferred from profile or language	Pakistan
Seller Type	Individual / trader / market / unknown	Individual
Media Evidence	Photo / video present	Yes
Image Verification	Confidence level of species ID	High / Medium / Low
Trade Type	Sale / wanted / exchange / hunting	Sale
Language Used	Language of the post	Hindi
Keywords Detected	Keyword used to detect the post	“crane for sale”
Notes	Additional contextual information	Negotiation in comments

4. Priority Species for Monitoring

Focus on cranes and a few waterbirds commonly involved in trade.

Cranes

1. Siberian Crane (*Leucogeranus leucogeranus*)
2. Demoiselle Crane (*Anthropoides virgo*)
3. Eurasian Crane (*Grus grus*)
4. Black-necked Crane (*Grus nigricollis*)

5. Sarus Crane (*Grus antigone*)

Other Waterbirds of Interest

Ducks & Geese (Primary Trade Group)

- Bar-headed Goose (*Anser indicus*)
- Greylag Goose (*Anser anser*)
- Ruddy Shelduck (*Tadorna ferruginea*)
- Common Teal (*Anas crecca*)
- Northern Pintail (*Anas acuta*)
- Northern Shoveler (*Spatula clypeata*)
- Gadwall (*Mareca strepera*)
- Eurasian Wigeon (*Mareca penelope*)
- Common Pochard (*Aythya ferina*)
- Ferruginous Duck (*Aythya nyroca*)
- Tufted Duck (*Aythya fuligula*)
- Red-crested Pochard (*Netta rufina*)
- Baikal Teal (*Sibirionetta formosa*)
- Falcated Duck (*Mareca falcata*)

Dominant in trade (meat, hunting, live markets)

Waders & Shorebirds

- Black-tailed Godwit (*Limosa limosa*)
- Ruff (*Calidris pugnax*)
- Common Snipe (*Gallinago gallinago*)
- Wood Sandpiper (*Tringa glareola*)
- Eurasian Curlew (*Numenius arquata*)
- Whimbrel (*Numenius phaeopus*)
- Marsh Sandpiper (*Tringa stagnatilis*)
- Green Sandpiper (*Tringa ochropus*)
- Temminck's Stint (*Calidris temminckii*)

Mainly hunting/subsistence-driven trade

Large Waterbirds (Storks, Pelicans, Ibis, Spoonbills)

- Eurasian Spoonbill (*Platalea leucorodia*)
- Asian Openbill Stork (*Anastomus oscitans*)
- Painted Stork (*Mycteria leucocephala*)

- Black-headed Ibis (*Threskiornis melanocephalus*)
- Black Stork (*Ciconia nigra*)
- White Stork (*Ciconia ciconia*)
- Great White Pelican (*Pelecanus onocrotalus*)
- Dalmatian Pelican (*Pelecanus crispus*)

Low frequency but high visibility trade

Other Wetland Birds (Opportunistic Trade)

- Purple / Grey-headed Swamphe (*Porphyrio porphyrio* / *P. poliocephalus*)
- Common Coot (*Fulica atra*)
- Common Moorhen (*Gallinula chloropus*)
- Pheasant-tailed Jacana (*Hydrophasianus chirurgus*)
- Bronze-winged Jacana (*Metopidius indicus*)
- Little Cormorant (*Microcarbo niger*)

Common in local wetland harvesting & informal markets

5. Trade Indicators to Monitor

Posts containing evidence of:

- Sale advertisements
- Requests to buy birds
- Captured birds offered for trade
- Hunting or trapping equipment
- Shipment or transport discussions

Common indicators include:

- price listed
- contact details
- “available now”
- cage photos
- multiple birds in captivity

6. Core English Search Strings

a. Direct Sale Keywords

These capture clear sale advertisements.

- crane for sale
- cranes for sale
- crane bird for sale
- live crane for sale
- sarus crane for sale
- demoiselle crane for sale
- black necked crane for sale
- crane chicks for sale
- crane pair for sale
- crane birds available
- waterbirds for sale
- water bird for sale
- wild birds for sale
- exotic birds for sale
- migratory birds for sale
- wetland birds for sale

b. Purchase / Demand Keywords

These help detect buyers searching for birds.

- buy crane
- looking for crane
- want to buy crane
- crane wanted
- crane bird needed
- waterbird wanted
- want to buy wild birds

- looking for migratory birds
- need crane pair
- crane breeder

c. Price / Advertisement Keywords

Often traders mention price or deal terms.

- crane price
- crane bird price
- sarus crane price
- crane pair price
- crane chicks price
- best price crane
- crane available now
- crane ready for sale
- cheap crane bird
- crane deal

d. Bird Market / Trade Keywords

These may reveal marketplaces or trade networks.

- bird market
- wild bird market
- live bird market
- migratory bird market
- crane bird market
- exotic bird market
- bird trader
- bird dealer
- bird supplier

e. Capture / Hunting Related Keywords

Important because many traded birds come from hunting or trapping.

- crane hunting
- crane trapping
- crane caught
- captured crane
- wild crane caught
- migratory bird hunting
- wetland bird hunting
- crane hunting video
- crane trap

f. Transport / Shipment Keywords

Some traders advertise transport or delivery.

- crane shipment
- bird shipping available
- crane delivery
- live bird transport
- crane export
- crane import
- birds transported

g. Social Media Style Keywords

These mimic the casual language used in posts.

- crane bird available
- crane pair available
- crane for pet
- pet crane bird
- crane baby bird
- crane breeding pair
- crane farm birds

h. Species-Specific Combinations

Useful for targeting priority crane species.

Siberian Crane

- Siberian crane for sale
- Siberian crane chicks
- Siberian crane price

Sarus Crane

- Sarus crane for sale
- Sarus crane pair
- Sarus crane price

Demoiselle Crane

- Demoiselle crane for sale
- Demoiselle crane price

Eurasian Crane

- Eurasian crane for sale
- common crane bird sale

i. Waterbird Trade Keywords

These can capture non-crane waterbirds often sold in the same markets.

- duck for sale
- wild duck sale
- goose for sale
- wild goose sale
- waterfowl for sale
- wild waterbird sale
- migratory duck sale
- wetland birds sale

3. Code Words and Slang

Wildlife traders often **avoid direct terms like “sale.”**

Interns should watch for words such as:

- available
- inbox
- DM for price
- ready
- contact
- pair ready
- breeder pair
- farm birds

Screenshot and Evidence Protocol

Interns should always capture visual evidence when they find a relevant post.

Guidelines

- Take a screenshot of the full post (including username, date, and image).
- Save the screenshot with a unique ID ie. Record ID

Ethical and Data Protection Notes

- Only public posts will be monitored.
- Personal data should not be stored unnecessarily.
- Screenshots must exclude private contact information where possible.
- Data will be used only for research and conservation enforcement support.